

May

8

2014

A rare find

Diver David Mearns found the oldest known astrolabe – an astronomical device used by sailors for navigation. It was found in the wreckage of the Portuguese ship *Esmeralda*, which sank in 1503.



Born this day

1926 David Attenborough, British broadcaster and naturalist. He is famous for his spectacular TV documentaries about natural history.

1975 Enrique Iglesias, Spanish-American singer. He is known as the King of Latin Pop.

Victory in Europe Day

1945

Cities across western Europe and North America celebrated the defeat of Nazi Germany in World War II. The hard-fought victory had come at the cost of millions of lives and widespread destruction.



Also on this day

1834 The first part of Hans Christian Andersen's *Fairy Tales* was published in Copenhagen, Denmark. It included the story of "The Princess and the Pea".

1902 Nearly 30,000 people died when Mount Pelée volcano erupted over the town of St Pierre, Martinique.

1996 The new constitution of South Africa was the first in the world to protect the rights of LGBTQ+ people.

1984

Thames barrier

Thousands watched as the UK's Queen Elizabeth II opened a set of 20 m (66 ft) tall steel gates built across the River Thames to prevent it from flooding central London.

